

May 25, 2021
Communication, Strategic Planning and Stakeholder Engagement
Subcommittee Meeting
Notes

Roll: Jenny Graham, Melanie McLaughlin, Kathy Kreatz here: 3 present, none absent

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Presenting draft of Strategic Plan
Achievement, Collaboration, Equity and Support: four sections
This strategic plan was a collaboration of 40 or so administrators.

[Link to slides here](#)

Poll: seeking opinion on two designs: one with a pyramid and one without.
Results: 71% no pyramid logo. 29% with a pyramid logo.

Peter Cushing: Top document linked to sub documents. Plans that a district should have going forward.

Suzanne Galusi: Hyperlinked on the front page for strategic improvement is a link to a glossary of terms: sample of the terms that are used in the document so that the greater community can learn more about each term used.

A for Achievement: (Suzanne Galusi and Bernadette Ricciardelli)

A1; Curriculum: ongoing curriculum review cycle
A2: Instruction: using evidence based instructional practices to implement the curriculum
A3: Assessments: common assessments to inform instruction and make modifications to our current curriculum. District wide common assessment tool with a common platform and common language: streamlined data so we can drill down to the specific needs of our students.
A4: Instructional technology and digital resource plan

C for Collaboration: (Peter Cushing and Nick Tucci)

C1: Build and sustain community partnerships that improve effectiveness (Relationships with CCSR, universities, internship opportunities for students, Family Network)
C2: Ensure that all families are welcomed members of the school community (family engagement events, curriculum nights, SEPAC events, surveys and communication with families about events)
C3: Engage in timely, thoughtful, two way culturally proficient communication with the Medford community (improve communication, use smart phone better, better translation services, better use of student information system, expanded opportunities for meeting with teachers using digital platforms, district controlled social media accounts, improvement of blog and website)
C4: Working collaboratively with community stakeholders to appropriate budgetary resources (more accessible budget documents to create stakeholders to provide input to school)

improvement plans); shift of use of MUNIS budget software package - connected to the city budget offices.

E is for Equity: (Suzanna Campbell).

As a district we are dedicated to the whole child. Stacey Schulman contributed greatly to this work but cannot be here tonight.

E1: Increase the support and understanding of health, wellness and social-emotional needs (annual assessment of current SEL programs so we can use the data to create district level action plans including Professional Development programs)

E2: Prioritize development of systems that support shared vision for disability awareness, anti-racism, anti-bias and cultural proficiency across the district.

Working to build a community that believes diversity is our strength. Action items: Racial equity task force focused on many initiatives one of which is attracting a more diverse staff using NEMNET and other hiring platforms. Equity audit due to begin this fall. District wide Disability Awareness curriculum for staff and students.

E3: Equal access to academics, support and enrichment. Audit of MTSSE which grew out of RTI and is more focused on the whole child not just on academics. Enrichment: extended day opportunities. MTSSE is for all students. New Dyslexia Guidelines: plan to develop actions from these guidelines.

E4: Ensure positive school culture. Restorative justice implementation at the secondary level districtwide, responsive classroom at elementary level. Culture climate action plan including school wide enrichment opportunities, shared cultural experiences, career exploration.

E5: Recruit, retain and develop an effective and diverse staff: expand human resources activities and partnerships with NEMNET and other organizations. Need to increase 484 staff: 5 Latino, 2 Black, 9 are Asian. Need a more diverse staff to better represent our students. MPDE: Mass Partnership Diversity in Education: another human resource group that we are using to attract a more diverse workforce.

S is for Support: (Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent)

Safe and secure learning environment

S1: Maintain and evaluate safety protocols: comprehensive safety procedures book, letters for principals, translated materials, equity in safety for all students in/staff. Multi-disciplinary Safety Working Group - lot of it under the Director of Health Services. Purchase of a communication system enabling multilingual technology.

S2: Build and Sustain partnerships with Community Organizations: PALS: partnership for advancing leadership skills: expand this k-12. Alive at the Middle School level but will be used K-12. Monthly meetings with stakeholders. IER (individualized Emergency Response Plan) needs - making sure we are not leaving anyone behind.

S3: Strategically utilize our finances to improve our learning environments: annualize capital improvement process and inventory. Dialog with MSBA.

Jenny Graham: Listening to principals give presentations, I am amazed by how many new things have been implemented this year. There has been a lot going on despite the pandemic. Also clear how much work has gone into this.

Kathy Kreatz: Thank you for this presentation and for all the work that went into it.

Melanie McLaughlin : I agree - this is such an interesting report. I have some feedback and comments. More polling with the school committee.

I appreciate the use of the glossary. Please have a non-educator read the document and look at any abbreviations.

Equity; glad to see assessment of curriculum for access to all students. Interested about the crossovers as there are items that fall into multiple categories.

I recommend getting the special education frameworks to all educators. For PD (under A2), helping families know about what PD is happening in the community. I encourage a pd list so that people know.

A3: modifications for current curriculum (maybe better wording - accommodations rather than changes to the curriculum). Training for families without a technology background.

Data cycle screenings: what does this mean?

Jenny Graham: I would like to talk about how we roll this out to the community? If we do this now, we will do it badly, but I would like to commit to doing this next year. State of the school district address. Think about collaboration in particular - start with the plan. Work with the community to redo the mission and vision and talk about bringing this document forward. Refine it to become powerful and compelling. I would like to see some explicit commitment to that kind of collaboration over the next year that takes this document from a requirement of NSIP to being a real grounding source for the staff and the community. The community hasn't been able to participate in this just yet but they should be parts of the plan. Not looking to button it up in June so it can start but work to bring it to the next iteration. Maintaining the plan has to be part of the plan. I don't think the subcommittee or SC needs to focus on wordsmithing this document but working on version two could be very powerful. It would be a sea level change in this district.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: We are able to make these commitments. The partnership with DESE and School and Main have led us to new potential opportunities to evolve as a district. It will be nice to implement some of the initiatives by January 2022 so that we can report out to the SC. It would be nice for people to be able to look back and look forward at the document. This is our strategy for improvement. The initiatives are happening across the district to bring about our outcomes for students. Every person has skin in the game with this plan. We are doing it as we are presenting it. I am committing to working on the mission/vision portion of the document to make it an inclusive experience for the community. Late fall. Need to give the community the opportunity to be familiar with what is happening in the district. This will be made public. This is our WHY. This is the work we will do for EVERYONE. We have all kinds of learners. Thank you to everyone who worked on this document.

Melanie McLaughlin: What is the process for next steps?

Jenny Graham: We can vote for you to present this at an upcoming meeting. I would suggest

June 14. We have not heard from the Racial Equity Task Force yet. I would ask that they weigh in on the PALS curriculum and the activities that go with it. The police in schools is a hot topic right now. I would like to hear from the RTF on the role of police in our schools, might be in the next school year.

Melanie McLaughlin : I would like to hear from the RTF. SEPAC has been talking about an Inclusion audit for many years. Disability is diversity; equity is inclusion. I am so glad these things are moving forward.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: We have one final RETF meeting this year. Getting information during this year when so many people have been remote would not have been accurate but getting the data from the audit will give us the correct information to make better recommendations to the district. I know there is a lot of conversation about different programs that are taking place, I do feel that the PALS program is an opportunity to connect with students in a school environment to have positive interactions with the police. Falls under the SEL umbrella Partnerships with the police and the schools will create better outcomes for all. In Medford, we truly have a collaboration with Chief Buckley and the PD.

Jenny Graham: Motion to bring to the School Committee. Kathy Kreatz/Jenny Graham

Roll: Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Kathy Kreatz: yes

Motion to adjourn the meeting: Melanie McLaughlin/Kathy Kreatz

Roll: Jenny Graham/Melanie McLaughlin/Kathy Kreatz YES